

[Space for C² Logo]

C²: Chalte Chalo

Turning a Vicious Cycle into a Virtuous One

The Transit Crisis: A Systemic Shortfall

National

\$140.2B U.S. transit infrastructure backlog. (Up 38% since 2018).

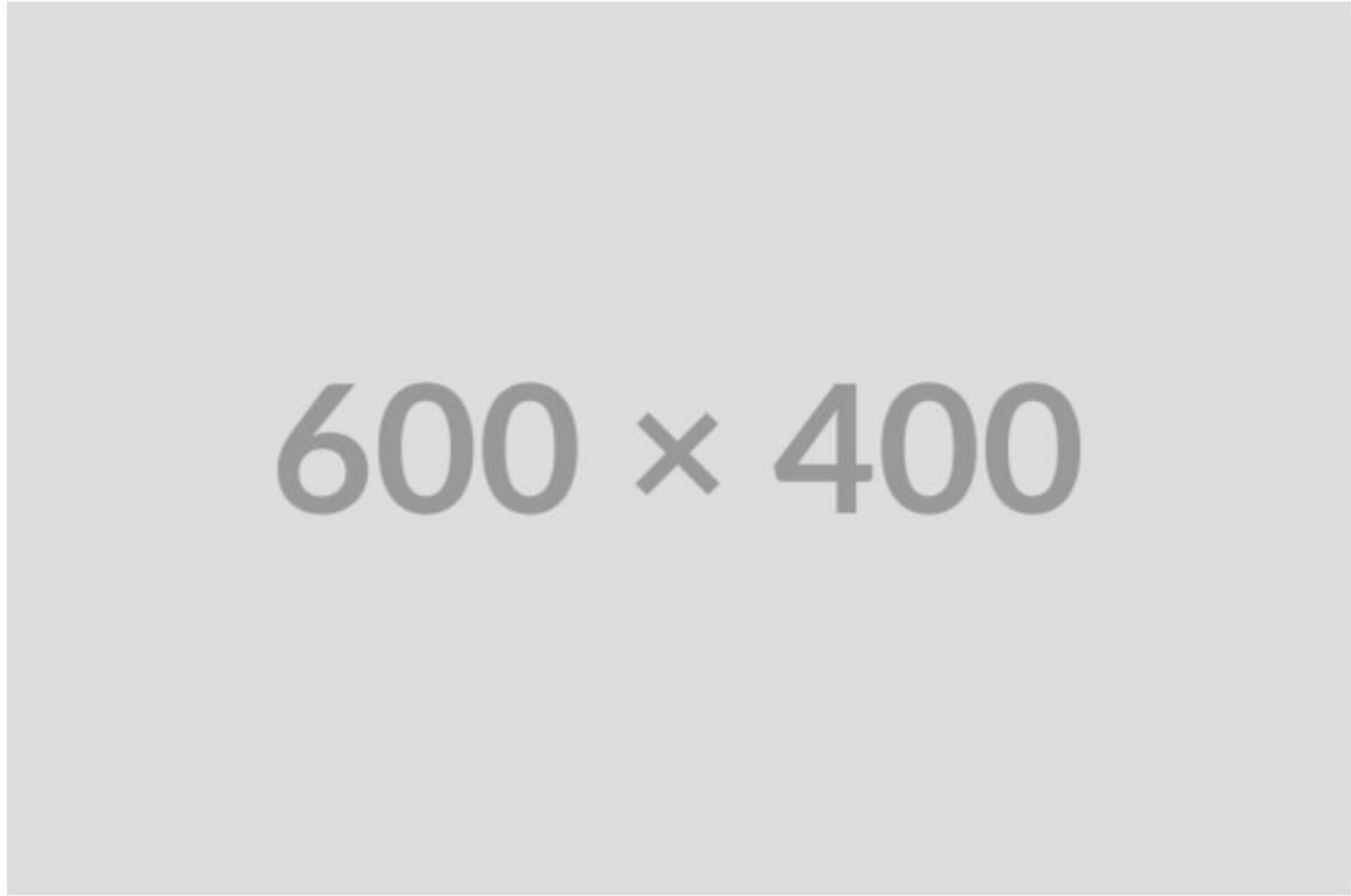
Regional

\$250M projected annual budget shortfall for Chicago's RTA.

Local

Projects on Hold for Champaign-Urbana MTD, impacting expansion.

The Death Spiral



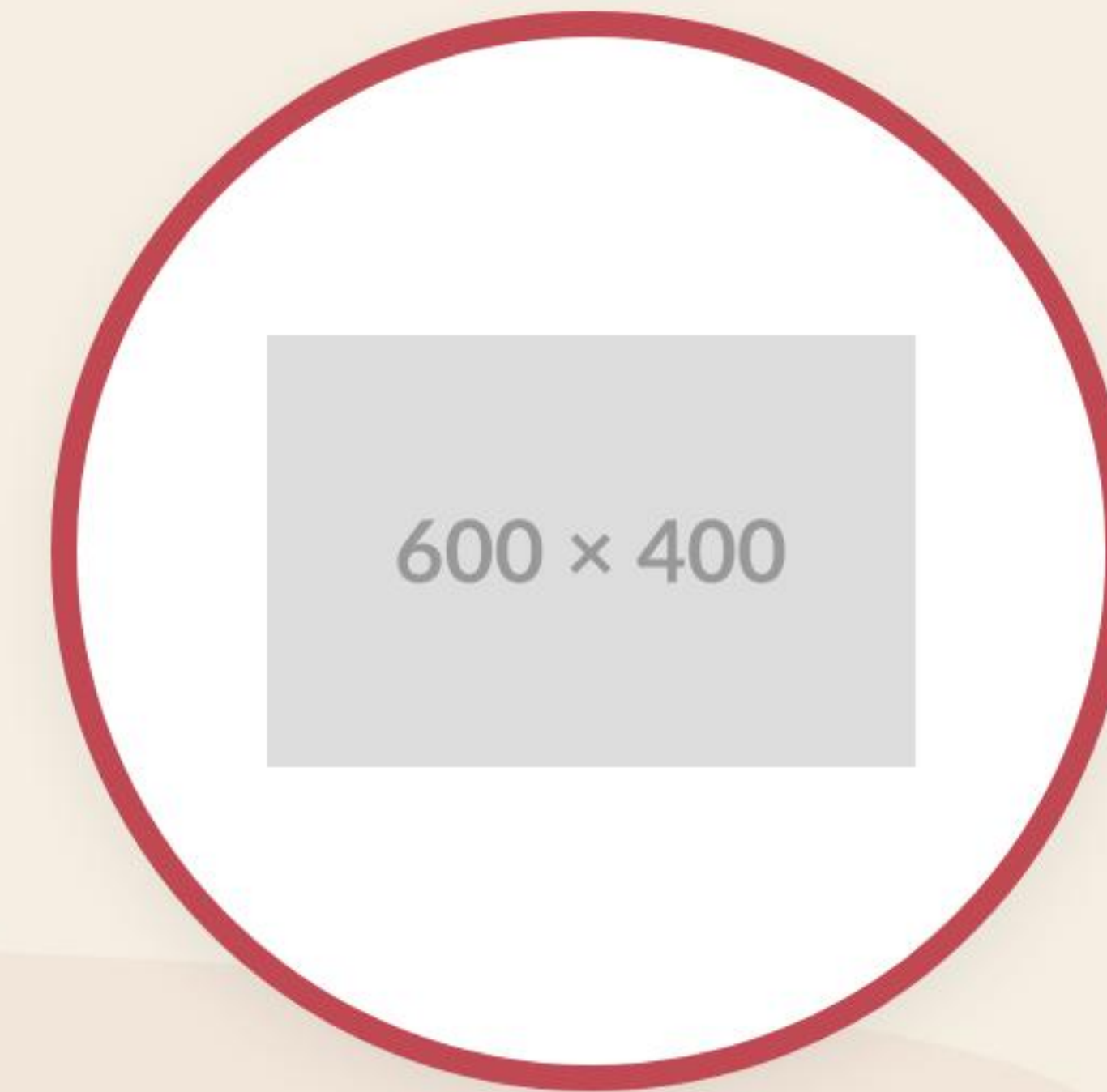
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Meet Maya: The Rider Problem

Key Survey Insights

- 60% of students surveyed don't use public transit.
- **Top Barriers:** Unreliable schedules, long wait times, and late buses.
- 75% said YES to a rewards app.
- **Top Motivators:** Local business discounts and food deals.

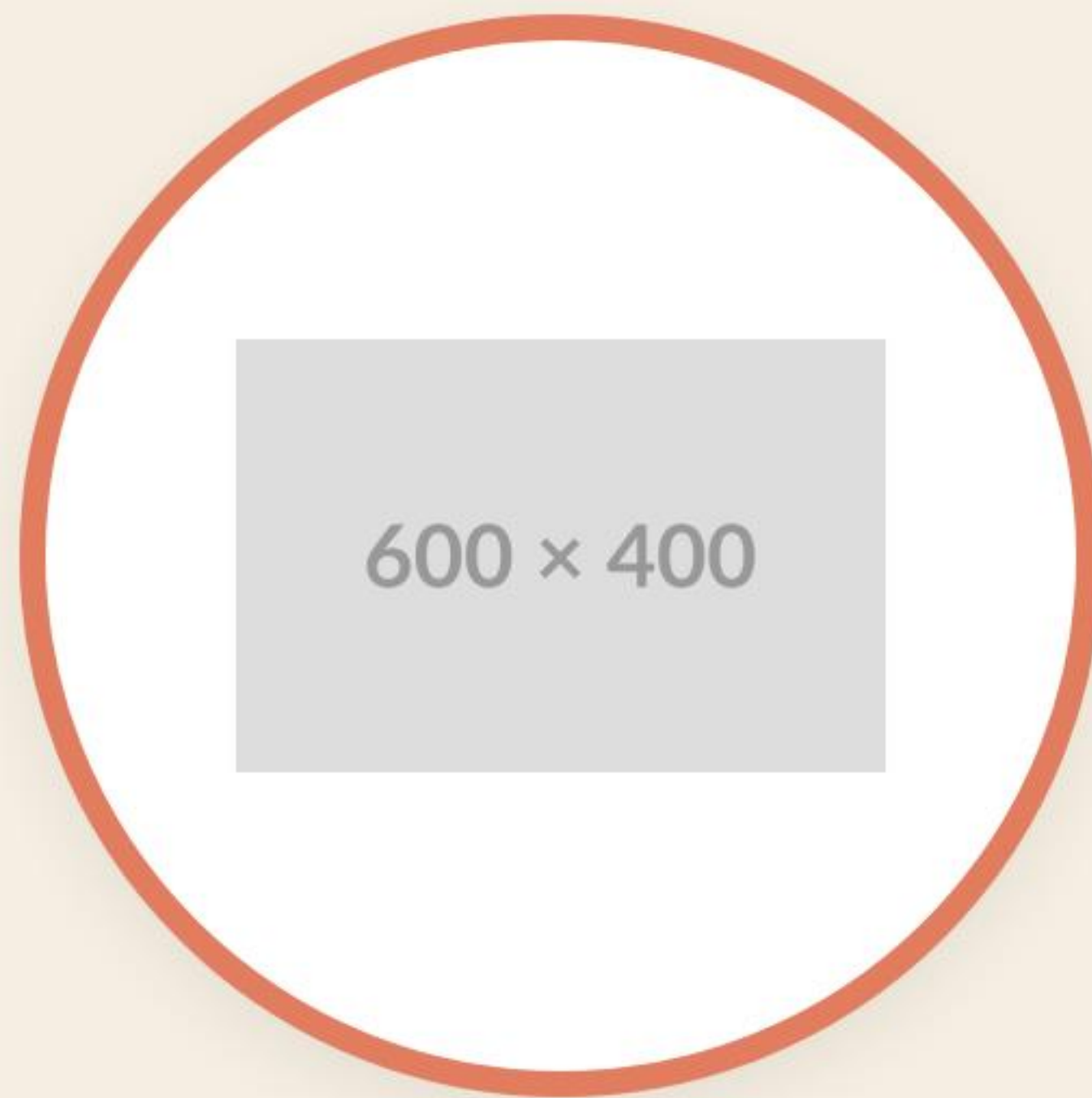
Maya needs a reason to choose the bus that is tangible and immediate.



"Bus is late... again."

"Why bother? I'll just walk."

Meet Sam: The Vendor Problem



"2 PM. Dead quiet."

"How do I reach students?"

The Challenge for Local Business

- **The "Afternoon Slump":** Packed at 8 AM, empty by 2 PM.
- **High Ad Costs:** Traditional ads cost \$5-10 per *click* with no guarantee of a customer.
- **The Need:** Sam needs guaranteed foot traffic, not just uncertain impressions.

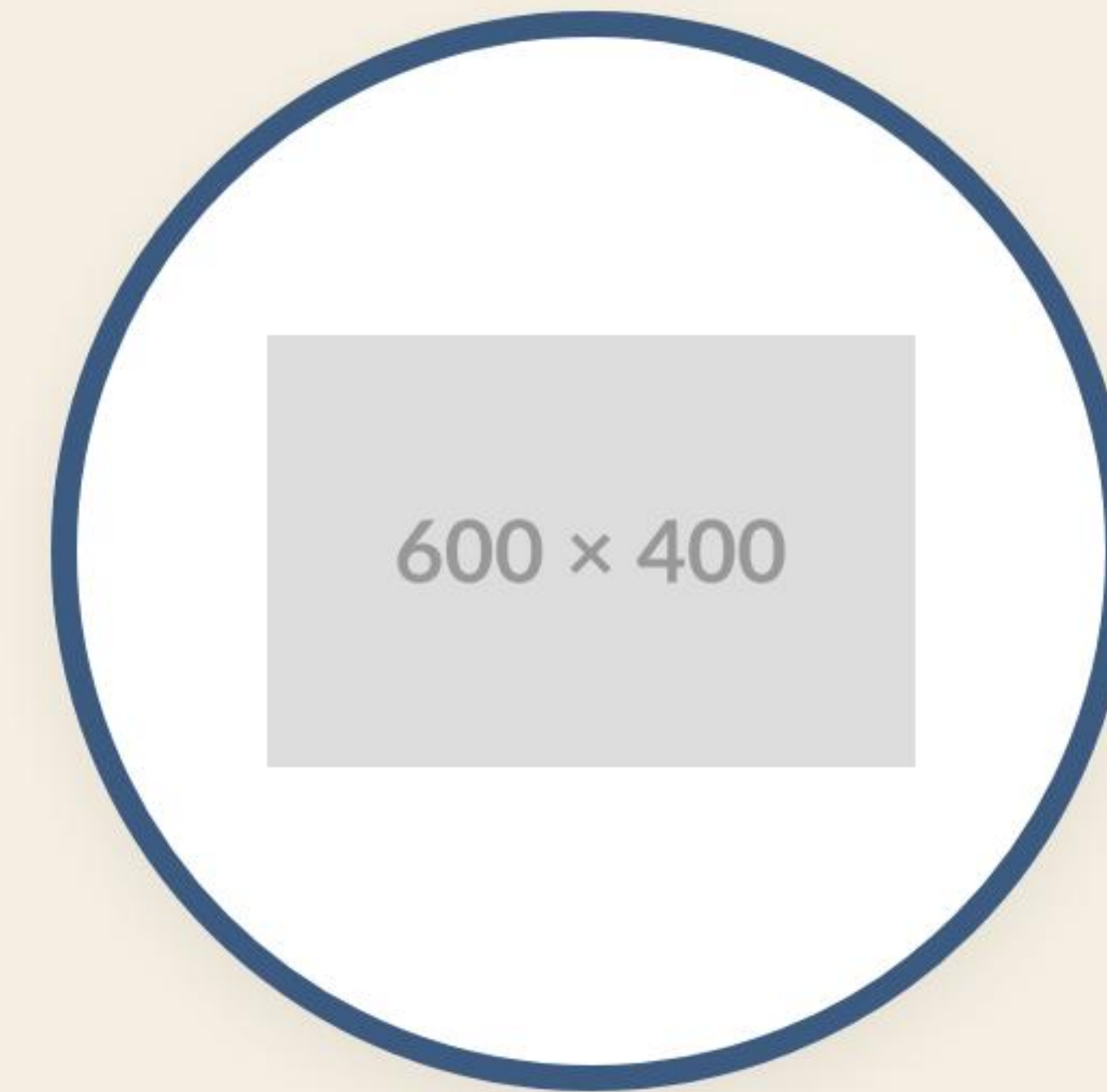
Sam needs a marketing channel where he only pays for a confirmed customer.

Meet Jordan: The Transit Authority Problem

Stuck in the Middle

- 46% of current MTD riders have no other car available.
- **The Catch-22:** Needs ridership to justify funding, but needs funding to improve service.
- **The Goal:** Must prove ridership is growing to secure state funding and grants.

Jordan is trapped between declining revenue and a dependent user base.



"Ridership is down, funding is at risk."

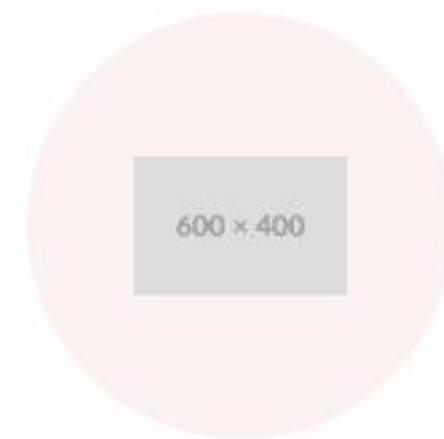
"How do we prove our value?"

Introducing C²: The Connected Ecosystem



Maya (Rider)

Takes the bus and automatically earns points for every ride.



Sam (Vendor)

Gains guaranteed foot traffic and new, loyal customers.



Jordan (MTD)

Sees ridership increase, justifying funding and optimizing routes.

Engineering via Human-Centered Design

We started with a problem, not a solution.

- **Learning 1:** Speed & Reliability matter more than cost.
- **Learning 2:** Environmental impact alone is not a primary motivator.
- **Learning 3:** Students want simple, engaging, and useful rewards.

Our Core Engineering Challenge

How do you *prove* someone is on a bus ride?

It must be:

- ✓ **Automatic**
- ✓ **Accurate**
- ✓ **Privacy-First**

Technical Innovation: 3-Layer Verification

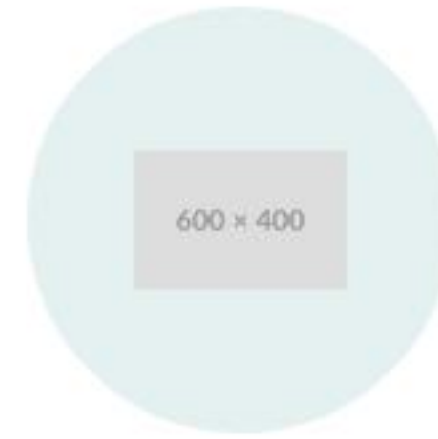


Layer 1: Motion Detection

On-device accelerometer detects bus-specific motion patterns. No data leaves the phone.

80–85%

Accuracy

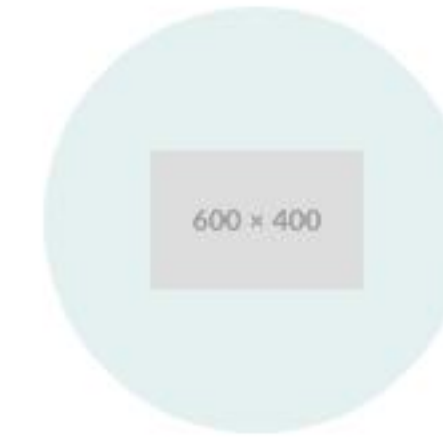


Layer 2: Geofence + Route

Cross-checks if user is at a bus stop and moving along a known route. Eliminates false positives.

92–95%

Accuracy



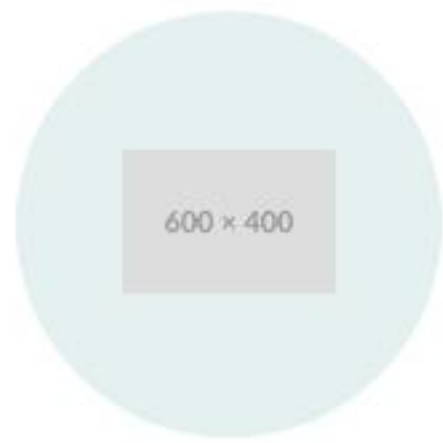
Layer 3: In-Bus Scan

A quick 3-second scan of a QR code or beacon for fraud resistance and a verifiable ride record.

>95%

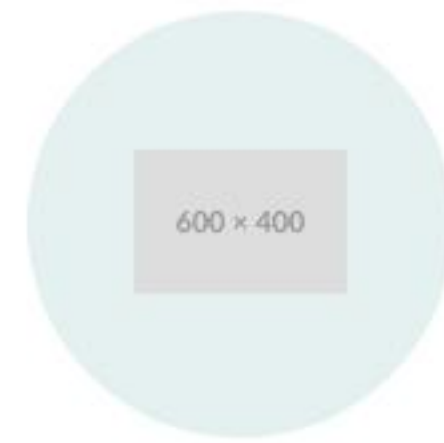
Accuracy

Behavioral Psychology: Why It Sticks



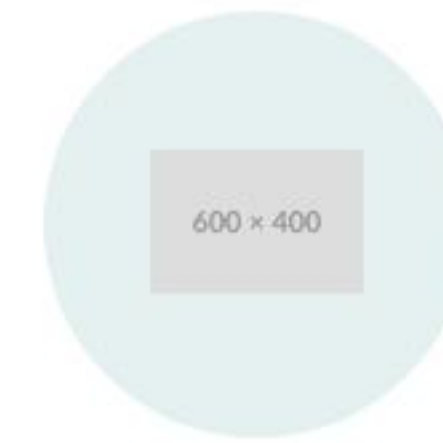
Habit Loops

Creates a "Cue (commute) → Routine (ride) → Reward (points)" cycle that reinforces behavior.



Loss Aversion

The fear of "breaking a streak" is a powerful motivator to ride, even on marginal days.



Social Proof

Leaderboards and community CO₂ savings make individual actions feel part of a meaningful group effort.

Business Model: Sustainable & Scalable

Vendor ROI (Sam)

10% off a \$7 order:

• Vendor Discount: \$0.70

• C² Fee: \$0.44

• Total Cost: \$1.14

Immediate ROI: 23%

(vs. \$5-10 for a single Google Ad *click*)



C² Revenue Model

2% + \$0.30

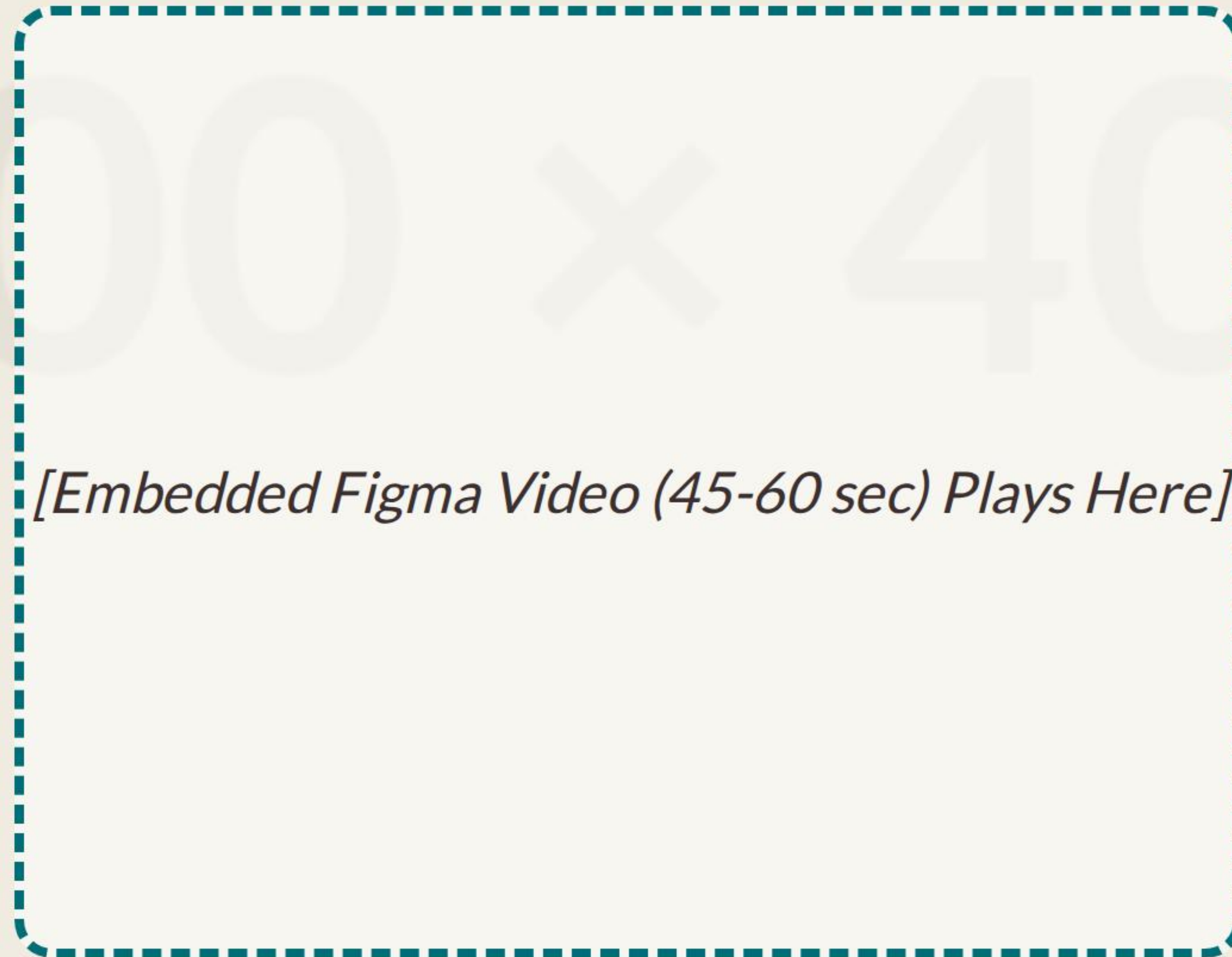
per confirmed redemption

Pilot Phase (5 vendors):

\$880 / month

Let's See It In Action

Figma Prototype Demonstration



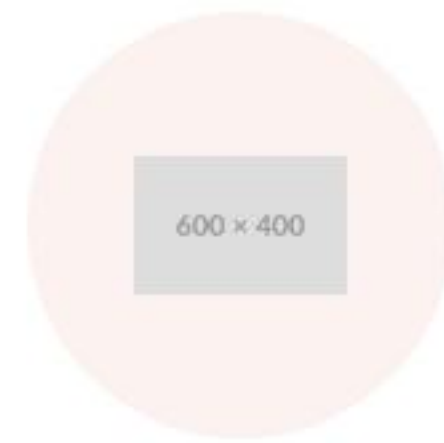
6000 x 4000

Impact Projections: A Win-Win-Win



For Maya (Riders)

- **\$15+** in rewards per semester.
- Real-time **CO₂** tracking.
- Community engagement.



For Sam (Vendors)

- **23%** immediate ROI.
- **\$1.14** per confirmed customer.
- Actionable loyalty data.



For Jordan (MTD)

- **+3,600** new regular riders.
- Increased **state funding**.
- Route optimization data.

Implementation



Phase 2: Pilot (MVP)

(4-6 Mos) \$30-60K

Launch MVP with 100-500 users and
3-5 vendor partners. Prove vendor
ROI.

Competitive Advantage

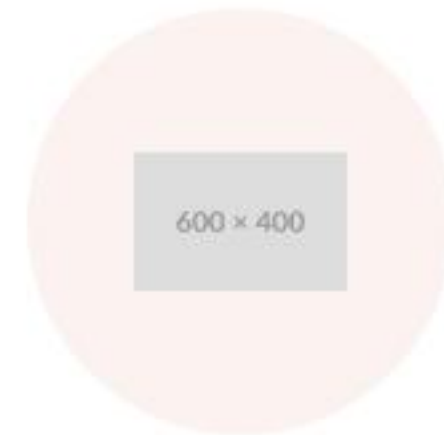
Feature	Competitors (EZfare, VTA)	C²: Chalte Chalo
Rewards	Free bus passes, generic gift cards	Local Business Ecosystem
Psychology	Basic points system	Habit Loops + Loss Aversion
Impact	None	Real-time CO ₂ Dashboard
Detection	Manual logging or ticketing	Automatic 95%+ Accuracy

Risks & Mitigation



Risk: Privacy Concerns

Mitigation: All data processed on-device. FERPA-compliant, anonymized data, and clear opt-in consent.



Risk: Competition

Mitigation: Exclusive local partnerships and official university endorsement that other apps cannot replicate.



Risk: Vendor Retention

Mitigation: Flexible terms and a transparent analytics dashboard showing clear, undeniable ROI.

The Bigger Picture: Flipping the Cycle

The Vicious Cycle (Now)

600 × 400

The Virtuous Cycle (With C²)

600 × 400

600 × 400

Join us.

We are seeking partners to pilot C² this spring semester.
Let's keep Champaign-Urbana moving.

Thank You.